Challenges and resilience in aphasia research: perspectives from Hispanic/Latino researchers in the US.

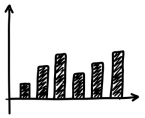
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1. Are Hispanic/Latinos underrepresented in the field?

- ~19% of the US population.
- ~5.4% of NIH-funded PIs identify as Hispanic (NIH, 2021).
- ~7.3% of ASHA members identify as Hispanic/Latino (ASHA, 2021; 2024).



2. Is underrepresentation a problem?

- Benefits of identity-concordant mentorship (Gladstone & Cimpian, 2021).
- Lived experiences of bilingualism and biculturalism.
- Culturally responsive research and practice.
- Recruitment of diverse scholars (Graves et al., 2022).
- Scientific innovation (Swartz et al., 2019).



3. Invisible" work

3.1 Doing & being

- Limited evidence for Hispanic/Latino adults with aphasia.
- Fewer citations.
- Trust-building with historically marginalized communities.
- The first or only.
- Cultural and linguistic bridge.



3.2 Research funding

- Underrepresentation in funded researchers (Nguyen et al., 2023).
- Grant terminations.
- Diversity-related language (Lee, 2025; Randazzo et al., 2025; Mehta & Jena, 2025).
- Limited assessment and treatment tools for Hispanic/Latino populations (Grasso et al., 2023; Forero et al., 2023).



3.3 International Collaborations

- Partnerships in Latin America.
- Dual IRB processes.
- Administrative, linguistic, and currency barriers.
- Translation beyond words.



3.4 Identity and intersectionality

- Ethnicity, language, immigration, first-generation status.
- Academic work in English, community work in Spanish.
- Liminality, multiplicity of belonging (Gaither, 2018), intersectionality (Crenshaw, 1989, 1991).



3.5 Mental health

- Burnout in academia (Hammoudi Halat et al., 2023; Nicholls et al., 2022).
- Stigma.
- Reduced family proximity for immigrant faculty, but family is culturally central (Campos & Kim, 2017; Perez & Cruess, 2014).

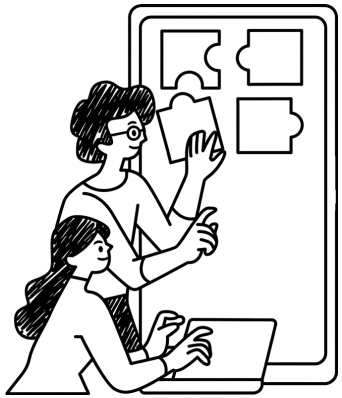


4. Cultivating Resilience

4.1 Resourcefulness.

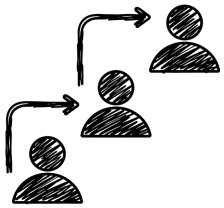
- Finding a way
- Collective survival traditions (Durston, 1999; Portes & Sensenbrenner, 1993).
- Leveraging service for networks and impact (Trejo, 2020).





4.2 Resilience in building representation for future scholars

- Visibility shapes belonging
- Hope for future scholars.



"Tomorrow there'll be more of us."





4.2 Resilience in community networks

- Mentorship and peer support.
- Community validation and purpose.
- Ecologically valid research
- Resilience is a strength, but **not** a substitute for institutional responsibility.

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